The Lighthouse

A peace, research, and education center for artists, activists, and practitioners, on the Mediterranean.



Where do activists and free thinkers gather across borders? Right now, nowhere they own.

Post-Oslo organizations failing

Most of the post-Oslo organizations that once held cross-regional gathering space pulled back or shut down after the events of 2023.

Burned out activists

The people who kept at the work are worn out, scattered, and in many cases pushed out of their home countries.

Lack of value aligned spaces in Europe

In Europe, the peace field rents its venues from commercial operators that share none of its values.

Lack of safe spaces

There is a need for a dedicated time and space where transformation can happen. Where the weight of violence is held collectively, and the work of liberation can begin.



The challenge

No space to meet

A region full of borders, violence, and ongoing conflict. SWANA artists and activists are worn out, scattered, and often exiled from their home communities.

The hard work

Building bridges across borders takes deep, shared reflection time and a safe container. Right now that exists in neither protected space nor protected time.

What is missing

Most people in this work have nowhere to put down what they carry. The Lighthouse is where they can, for long enough to rest, work through it, and build with people from across the divide.



The solution

A place that hosts individuals and groups along their activist journey, supported by people with similar experience, where the weight of conflict is witnessed and carried together.

Rest and be held

Through rest, meditation, wellness practice, and the steadying presence of others who understand.

Learn and grow

Knowledge, skills, and relationships participants take back to their communities and their work.

Heal

Time and space to process what the work and the region ask people to carry.





How it works: four tracks

Individuals and groups are invited, or apply, to join for short or longer programs. The center employs facilitators, therapists, and practitioners on a project basis.

Peace research and healing

Direct work on inherited trauma, structural racism, land connection, and embodied practice.

Artivism

Residencies and collaborations for artists pressing on political reality.

Regeneration

Permaculture, natural building, and indigenous land knowledge.

Social entrepreneurship

Skills, mentorship, and funding for community institutions.



The work is already happening: Kosmic Kamels and adjacent projects in the existing network

8

Years of operation

Continuous operation since 2018, without a permanent home.

200 +

People per year

Roughly 30 to 100 community members per project.

Governance and operating model

A founding team of three, with governance designed for continuity beyond the founders.

On-site operations

Year one: site location and project management. After opening: daily facilitation, community care, logistics.

Finance and strategy

Capital raise, sustainability planning, institutional partnerships.

Community building

Program design, the participant journey, alumni networks.



The structure is built to outlast its founders and to be accountable to the communities it serves.



The landscape we are seeking

Site selection criteria

- Natural setting with beauty and accessibility
- No more than 1.5 hours from international airport
- Capacity for 30 to 50 residential and 200 or more for public events
- Indoor and outdoor workshop spaces
- Permission for amplified sound and cultural programming
- Camping or accommodation for participants
- An existing building with a light retrofit, for lower capex and a faster opening

Geographies

The Mediterranean basin, with Portugal and Spain leading the shortlist, Catalonia first among them.

We are seeking a site that can serve as both a sanctuary and a working campus, rooted in the land and open to the region.

It pays for itself, and the demand is already there.

The peace field in Europe rents its venues from commercial operators that share none of its values.

180+

Peace organizations

Israeli and Palestinian peace organizations in the ALLMEP network. Most meet abroad because meeting in the region is hard.

100K+

Residential dialogue attendees

People a year attend residential dialogue programs across about 2,000 events.

9.2M

Market value per year

Worth roughly 9.2 million euros a year in full-board spend.

€381K

Annual hosting income

Income from hosting external events, before we run a program of our own.

⚠ In 2024 there were 61 armed conflicts across 36 countries, the most since 1945, ten of them in the Middle East. Safe spaces that protect political imagination and support new forms of leadership are needed now more than ever.



Capital ask and roadmap

Funding required in stages.

1 **Year one**

Feasibility grant
€100K to €300K.

2 **Year two**

Site acquisition
€2.5M to €4M. Once the site is located and approved.

3 **Years two to three**

Renovation and light retrofit
€1M to €1.5M.

4 **Years one to three**

Operating bridge
€1.4M to €1.8M.

5 **Year five**

Operating budget fully covered by earned revenue.

Total capital ask: €5M to €7M, anchored by a lead donor.

The feasibility grant

ABOUT €120,000 OVER TWELVE MONTHS

Budget breakdown

Line item	Amount
Pilot residency	€40K
Core team salaries, half-time, 12 months (2 roles)	€40K
Site seeking and project management	€8K
Brand building and marketing	€5K
Legal and administrative setup	€15K
Contingency (10%)	€11K

What this year delivers

> A pilot run and the core team in place

- A located and approved site
- A governance and conflict protocol ready for funders
- A brand and outreach presence live
- Legal entity established and compliant

Operational sustainability (year five)

Annual cost structure

Cost line	Range
Site running	€260K to €365K
Staff salaries, 8 to 12 roles	€170K to €330K
Program delivery and scholarships	€80K to €150K
Signature events	€90K to €180K
Publishing and outreach	€20K to €40K
Legal, admin, insurance	€30K to €60K
CapEx reserve	€40K to €70K
Total cost	**€690K to €1.2M**

Annual revenue streams

Revenue line	Range
Education programs	€380K to €870K
Signature events	€300K to €650K
Resident contributions	€150K to €280K
Hospitality and rentals	€120K to €280K
Publishing and additional	€5K to €20K
Total earned	**€760K to €1.8M**

By year five, earned revenue covers operations in full and runs a surplus. Philanthropy funds capital and scholarships, never the running of the place.

Additional sources of income

Foundation and catalytic funding

EU funding for infrastructure, Peace-building initiatives, arts and culture programs, regional cooperation and reconciliation.

Individual donors

High-net-worth impact funders, annual campaigns, sustaining-donor programs.

Institutional partnerships

University research collaborations, think tanks and policy institutes, international NGOs.

Business development

Consulting and facilitation, training programs for organizations, licensing the model to other sites.



POTENTIAL SITE

Existing place that's ready to start.

A historic farmhouse estate in Canet d'Adri, Catalonia.

15 km from Girona, 25 minutes from Girona airport, 1 hour 20 from Barcelona. Cheaper than the 6 million euro Feytopia anchor, in the same region as an established peace-training centre.

2,000,000 euros

Asking price. 23 hectares. About 45 beds after a light retrofit.

3.95M euros

Total capital stack all in: purchase, transfer tax, buildout, and first-year working capital.

87,000 euros

Operating surplus near 87,000 euros before philanthropy, at 45 beds base case.

What it looks like at full stride

> Kids who speak three languages running through a courtyard that was empty farmland a decade earlier. A Palestinian artist and an Israeli researcher working out a regional exhibit over morning coffee. Alumni in twenty cities shipping work together. Once a year, the whole network comes home for a week on the land.

Contact

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